Week 9 | Real-book guide

December 14 to 18 | Shared work turns a stubborn problem into a result everyone can explain.

One book, all subjects

Big Pumpkin | Shared work turns a stubborn problem into a result everyone can explain. Math: Measure and share pumpkin models, then show the final week's fraction or capacity reasoning. Science: Choose one energy or motion idea from the story setting, test it, and explain the observed evidence. Social studies: Present a problem, a group action and the result using the story's shared-work structure. Finish: Create a learning-gallery display with a pumpkin problem/solution sequence and one evidence card.

Grade 3 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-12-14: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-15: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-16: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-17: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-18: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-12-14: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-15: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-16: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-17: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-18: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.